

Help Ladder: Real Practice



BIG IDEA *Telling someone is a skill. Skills get easier with practice, and the first adult you tell is not the only adult you can tell.*

1 HOOK 2'

2 ACTIVITY 8'

3 DISCUSS 3'

4 TAKEAWAY 2'

PREP IN 5 MINUTES

Materials: Workbook CF-1 and My Help Ladder card; R1 sets (Barrier Cards per group; Tell-3, Listener and Bumpy Response Cards per triad).

- ☐ Cut the R1 sets (Barrier Cards per group; three cards per triad).
- ☐ Post the Help Ladder poster: yourself, a friend who comes with you, a trusted adult, a reporting channel.
- ☐ Read the disclosure box below; expect something real.

1 HOOK 2 MIN *60-second script* *Hackles up? That is the feeling that something is off. Trust it.* “Welcome to Case Files. For ten weeks you are analysts: you read short files about made-up people, find the pattern, and work out the best next move. Nobody ever has to share anything personal. Silently, think of a time you wanted to tell someone about a problem and held back. People hold back because telling feels hard, however small the problem. So today we practice telling, like a free throw.”

2 ACTIVITY 8 MIN *Barrier Busters and Tell-3*

- 1 (1 min) Read CF-1.** Jordan, twelve, gets a private game message: “Want to chat somewhere more private? Also, don’t tell anyone, okay?” Jordan worries: “They’ll take my tablet away.”
- 2 (2 min) Barrier Busters.** Groups pick the two Barrier Cards that fit Jordan and write one true sentence that makes telling easier.
- 3 (4 min) Tell-3 in triads** (Teller, Listener, Observer): “I need your help with something online.” One sentence about it. “Can you help me figure out what to do?” Listener: “Thank you for telling me. You are not in trouble.” Rotate every 80 seconds. In Round 3 the Listener is Bumpy and the Teller uses the Next-Rung Rule: “That was not the help I needed. I am going to tell someone else.”
- 4 (1 min) What happens next.** The adult listens, may bring in other helpers, and promises: “I will help, and I will not blame you.” Start the My Help Ladder card.

3 DISCUSS 3 MIN

- 1** “Why did Jordan almost not tell? Which barrier felt most real?”
- 2** “What did the Listener say or do that made the Teller feel safer?”
- 3** “What if the first person you tell does not help?” (Next-Rung Rule.)

4 TAKEAWAY 2 MIN “Pause, Check, Tell. Today was all about Tell. It is the strongest move in every case file, and it is never your fault. If the first person does not help, tell the next one.”

Hand signal: Hackles Up (hand brushed up the neck, optional), then Pause, Check, Tell. Post it: “First adult did not help? Next rung.”

EXIT TICKET Name one role you could tell and the first sentence you would say.

FUN BOOST Best Reply Challenge. Each triad draws a Bumpy Response Card and writes the calmest, most believable Teller reply in 60 seconds. Applaud believable, not funny.

LEVEL-UP Small-Stuff Rep. This week, practice Tell-3 on something tiny and true (a forgotten form). Tick “I did a rep” on a slip.

DIFFERENTIATE Offer sentence starters and the Observer role for two rounds; drawing the Ladder is fine.

FAMILY CARD Ask: “If something felt weird online, who would you tell first?” Say: “Thank you for telling me. You are not in trouble.”

IF A STUDENT TELLS YOU SOMETHING

- **Say:** “Thank you for telling me. You did the right thing.”
- “This is not your fault, and you are not in trouble.”
- “I can’t keep this secret. I need to bring in people who can help, and I will tell you who.”
- **Do not say:** “Are you sure?” or “Why didn’t you tell me sooner?”
- “I won’t tell anyone.”
- Asking to see messages, photos or accounts.

First 10 Minutes: see the Disclosure Guide.

Then: tell your counselor or designated person right away. Follow your school policy and your state’s reporting law.